Flourish
LEGAL WELL-BEING

Asking for Help as a Caregiver: The DESC Method

Every caregiver faces moments when they could use support, whether it's from family, community, or professional services.

The DESC method (created by Gordon Bower, Ph.D., and Sharon Bower, M.A.) can help you ask for that support clearly and without conflict.

D	**Describe**	State the situation clearly and without emotion.	**Example:** "I received a call from dad's doctor yesterday. He missed his appointment."
E	**Express**	Share how you feel using "I" statements.	**Example:** "I feel concerned that he'll miss his rescheduled appointment too."
S	**Specify**	Say exactly what you need from the other person.	**Example:** "I need your help getting dad to the doctor this Thursday at 10 AM."
C	**Consequence**	Explain what will happen if your need is or isn't met.	**Example:** "If you can help with this, I can handle his appointments next week. If not, I'm worried about burning out."